Dear Quillstone Payments Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. My experience building and operating NLP systems for Croatian-language documents, together with earlier work classifying customer complaints, aligns closely with your team's focus on helping merchants get answers quickly and supporting customer operations with practical AI products.

At Slavonica Document AI, I developed and deployed a document classifier serving approximately 15,000 documents per day using Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, FastAPI, Docker and Azure. I also hold the Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate certification (2024). I also built a Croatian named entity recognition model and created an annotated dataset of 4,000 documents, coordinating two annotators and achieving an inter-annotator kappa of 0.87. To help keep production performance reliable, I implemented weekly drift reporting and identified an OCR change associated with a nine-point accuracy drop; the issue was resolved within a week. These projects have given me hands-on experience with model serving, monitoring and MLOps tools including MLflow.

Earlier, at Baranjska kreditna banka, I developed customer complaint classification, progressing from a TF-IDF and logistic regression baseline to fastText across 11 topics, with weekly reporting for customer service management. I have also built a personal prototype for retrieval-augmented question answering over Croatian laws, using sentence embeddings and FAISS with an open-weight language model accessed through an API. This was a weekend project, not a production system, but it has given me practical experience exploring RAG.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring my NLP, production ML and customer-text experience to Quillstone's AI team, working with engineering and product colleagues to build practical systems that classify customer issues, support agent workflows and help merchants get answers quickly. Thank you for considering my application. I would be glad to discuss how my experience could contribute to the team.

Kind regards,
Petra Zlatarić-Novosel